Games and Activities Bank

Twenty-one low-cost games to start a class, wake children up, or fill spare minutes with learning

FOR VOLUNTEERS

- **Explain a game in one minute**, and show it once before children play. Keep rules simple.
- **Mix the teams** so that stronger and newer children play together, and let nobody be out for long.
- Care about **taking part more than winning**. Praise a good idea, a kind helper, a brave try.

Literacy games

Game	Level	You need	How to play
Letter hunt	1	Alphabet chart	Call a letter; children race to point to it on the chart. Then call a picture (আম) and children point to its letter (আ).
Sand and rice letters	1	A tray of sand or rice	Children draw the stroke or letter with a finger. Smooth the tray and draw again. It builds hand memory before the pencil.
Sound clap	1–2	None	Say a word slowly. Children clap once for each beat (আ-ম = 2, প্র-জা-প-তি = 4). Then let a child lead.
Rhyme chain	2	None	Say a word (কল). The next child says a word that rhymes (জল). Go round the circle until nobody can think of one. The last child to answer starts a new word.
Missing letter	1–2	Board, chalk	Write a word with one letter missing (ক_ল). Children say which letters fit and whether the word is real (কল, কাল, কিল).
Word-building cards	2	Letter and sign cards	In groups, children build as many real words as they can in three minutes, then read them to the class. A point for each real word; no point for nonsense words.
Spelling relay	2–3	Board, two chalks	Two teams line up. The volunteer says a word; one child from each team runs to write it. The team with the correct spelling gets a point.
Find the odd one out	2	Word cards	Show four words that rhyme and one that does not (কালো, ভালো, চালো, হাবা). Children spot the odd one and say why.

Numeracy games

Game	Level	You need	How to play
Stick boxes	2	Ice-cream sticks, 3 boxes	Call a number; children place sticks in the ones, tens and hundreds boxes. Swap roles: one child sets the sticks, the other says the number.
Digit cards: biggest number	2–3	Digit cards 0–9	Each child draws three cards and makes the biggest three-digit number. Then the smallest. Ask: "Which digit goes first, and why?" (place value).
Number and word pairs	2	Cards: numbers and their names	Lay all cards face down. Turn over two at a time; if a number matches its name (১২ and বারো) keep the pair. The one with most pairs wins.
Shop and pay	2–3	Play money, price tags	One child is the shopkeeper and the others buy two items and pay. The shopkeeper counts the total and the change. Great for money and addition.
Times-table clap	3	None	Say a table (৩-এর ঘর). Clap on every multiple (৩, ৬, ৯ ...) and say it aloud; stay silent on the others. Speed up as children get confident.
Fair sharing	3	20 counters or erasers	Ask: "Share 17 among 5, what happens?" Children share, find the remainder, and write it as a division sentence. Change the numbers.
Estimate and check	3	Slate or paper	Before each sum, children write an estimate. Then they work it out. A point for the closest estimate, and a point for the right answer.
Number riddles	3	None	"I am a two-digit number. My tens digit is 3 more than my ones digit, and my digits add up to 9." (63). Children make riddles for each other.

Science (the sky) games

Game	Level	You need	How to play
Shadow tag	All	Sunny playground	The "chaser" must step on another child's shadow, not touch them. Afterwards ask: "Which way did shadows point? When were they long?"
Sun, Earth, Moon dance	All	Three children, a lamp or a ball	One child is the Sun (stands still), one the Earth (spins slowly) and one the Moon (walks round the Earth). Everyone else says what the Earth child sees.
Day or night?	All	None	Say a sentence ("The stars are shining"). Children stand up for night, sit down for day. Add tricky ones: "The Moon is out in the afternoon."
Moon shape cards	All	8 cards drawn by children	Mix the eight cards. In groups, children put them in the order the Moon shows through the month and explain their order.

Game	Level	You need	How to play
Sky colour guess	All	Colour pencils	Say a time (6 am, noon, 6 pm, midnight). Children colour a sky for it. Compare and talk: why do the colours differ?

NOTE
The games are our suggestions, added to the programme. Please tell us which ones work, and change any rule that does not suit your class. A game that fits your children is better than one that follows our description.